

⚠ Trading gold, forex and CFDs on margin carries a high level of risk and you could lose more than your initial deposit. 70–80% of retail investor accounts lose money when trading CFDs. Past performance is not indicative of future results. All content is for education only and is not financial advice.

PREMIUM SOP · EDITION 01

COMBO ENTRY SOP

Take gold only where a trendline and a flipped level arrive at the same price. H4 sets the direction. H1 confirms the rejection. M15 gives you the entry.

08

Numbered missions

3

Timeframes in sequence
H4 · H1 · M15

1%

Max risk per setup

XAUUSD · intraday continuation · Reviewed by Sam · Education only

REVIEWED BY
Sam

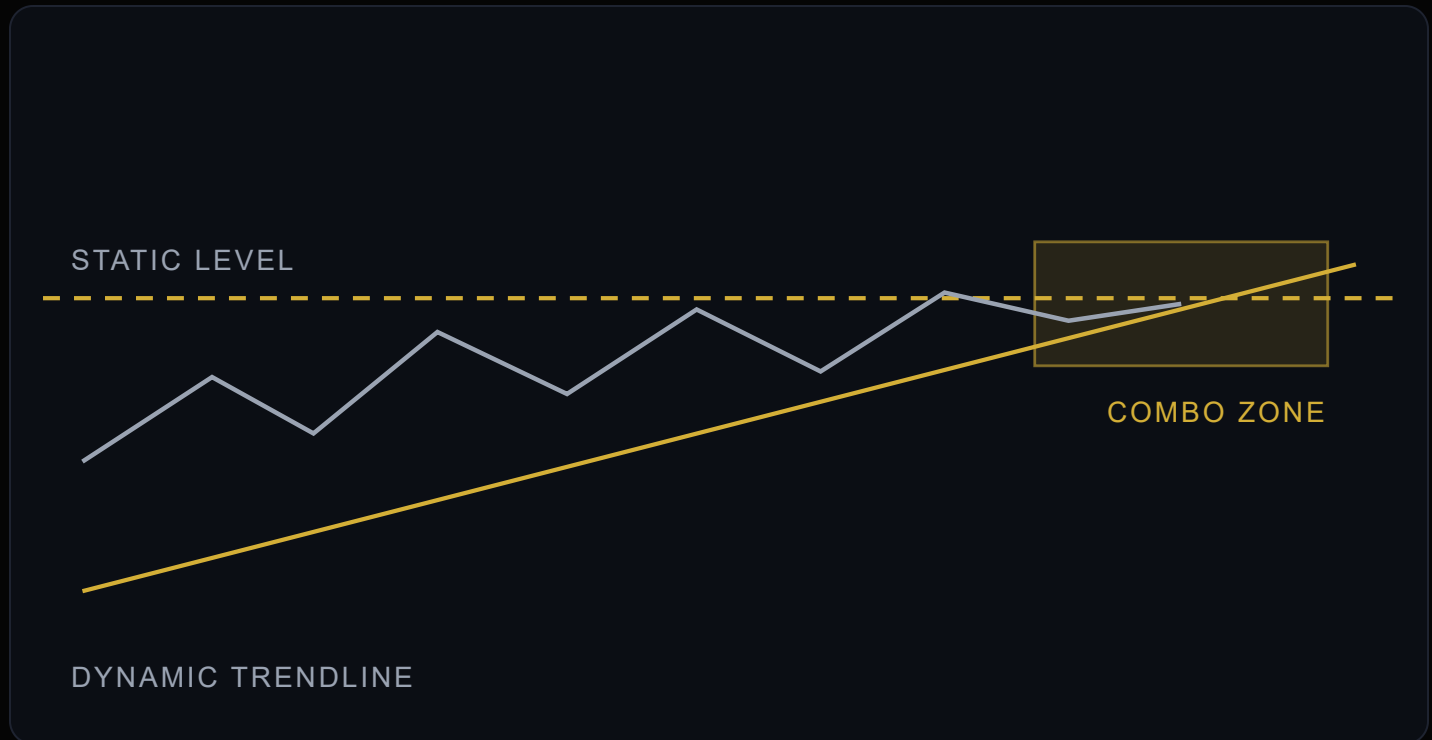
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READING THE STRUCTURE

Two kinds of level sit on a gold chart. One is static: a horizontal price the market has already turned at. One is dynamic: a trendline that climbs with every higher low. Most days they are far apart and there is nothing to do. When they arrive at the same price at the same time, you have a combo — one zone holding two independent reasons to trade. That overlap is the only entry this SOP takes.

FIGURE 1



Schematic. Two levels, one price. Away from the overlap you have half a reason, which is no reason.

MISSION 01

Establish the dominant trend

Objective — decide the one direction you are allowed to trade today, before you draw anything.

- Open XAUUSD on H4. Read the last 60 candles and nothing older.
- Uptrend: every swing high is a higher high and every swing low is a higher low.
- Downtrend: lower highs and lower lows. Mirror everything in this manual.
- Anything else is sideways. Sideways means no combo trade. Close the chart.
- Write the direction in your trading plan. You trade with it for the rest of the session or not at all.

Fail condition. If you cannot name the trend in ten seconds, it is sideways. Ten seconds is the test.

FIGURE 2



Schematic. Three higher highs and three higher lows. This is what "dominant uptrend" has to look like before mission 02 starts.

MISSION 02

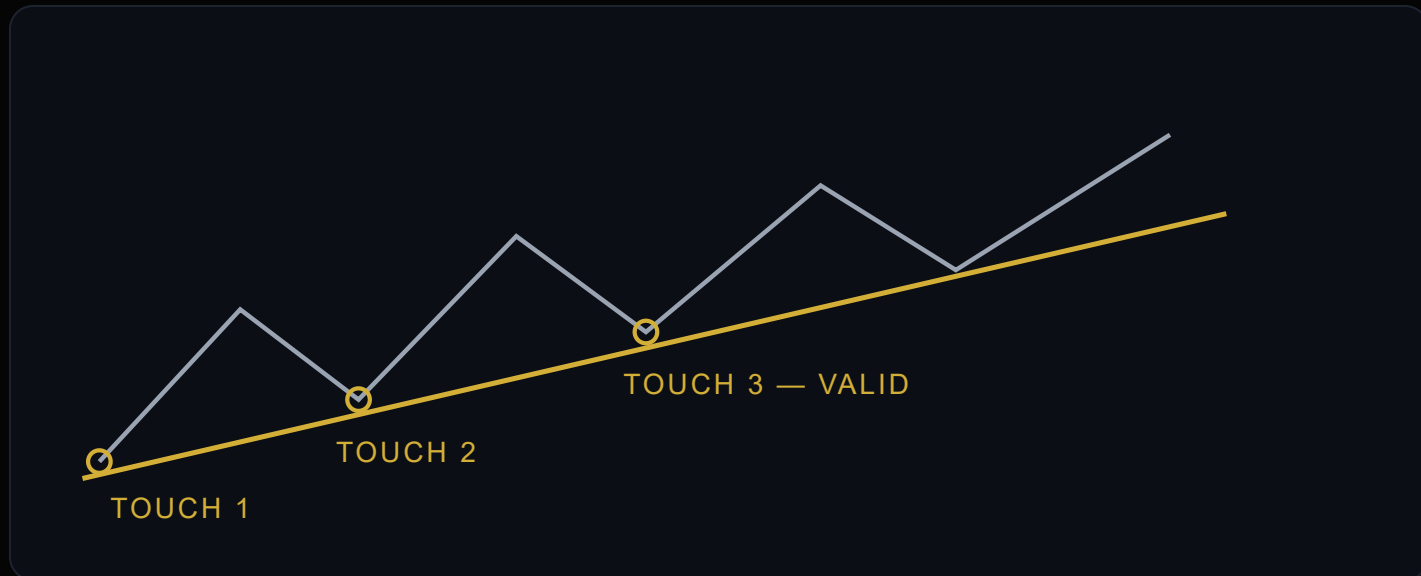
Draw the trendline price respects

Objective — one line, three touches, no redraws.

- In an uptrend connect the swing lows. In a downtrend connect the swing highs.
- Anchor on the wick extreme of each swing, not the body. The wick is where the market actually stopped.
- Two touches is a guess. Three touches is a trendline. Wait for the third.
- One line per chart. If you need a second line to explain price, you are describing sideways.

Fail condition. If you have to move the line to make it fit, the line is not there. Delete it and wait.

FIGURE 3



Schematic. The line only becomes a level on the third touch. Touches one and two are how you find it, not how you trade it.

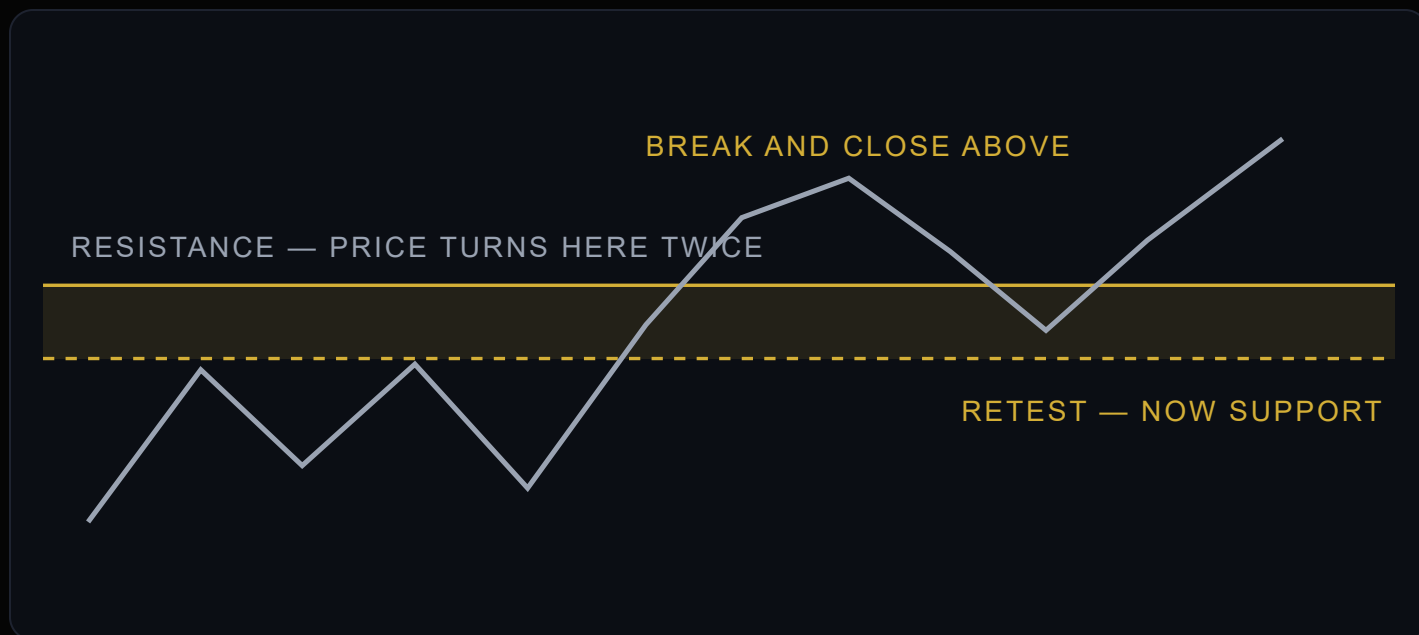
Mark the level that flipped

Objective — find the horizontal price that changed roles, and mark it as a zone.

- Find a resistance the market broke through and closed above on H4.
- Broken resistance becomes support at the same price. That role change is the flip.
- Mark it as a zone, from the body close to the wick extreme. On gold that is usually 30 to 60 pips wide.
- The more times price turned there before the break, the heavier the level. Three prior turns beats one.
- A level is a zone, never a line. Gold spikes through lines for a living.

Invalidation. A full H4 candle closing back on the wrong side of the zone kills the level. It is no longer support. Remove it from the chart and stand down.

FIGURE 4



Schematic. Same price, opposite job. The retest is the trade; the break is not.

STANDING RULES — PART I

ONE TREND

One direction per session, named on H4 before anything is drawn.

ONE TRENDLINE

Three touches or it does not exist.

ONE LEVEL

A flipped zone, 30 to 60 pips, body to wick.

THE COMBO

You now have a trend, a trendline and a flipped level. None of them is a trade. The trade is the moment all three point at the same price on the same candle. Part II is the waiting, and the waiting is most of the work.

MISSION 04

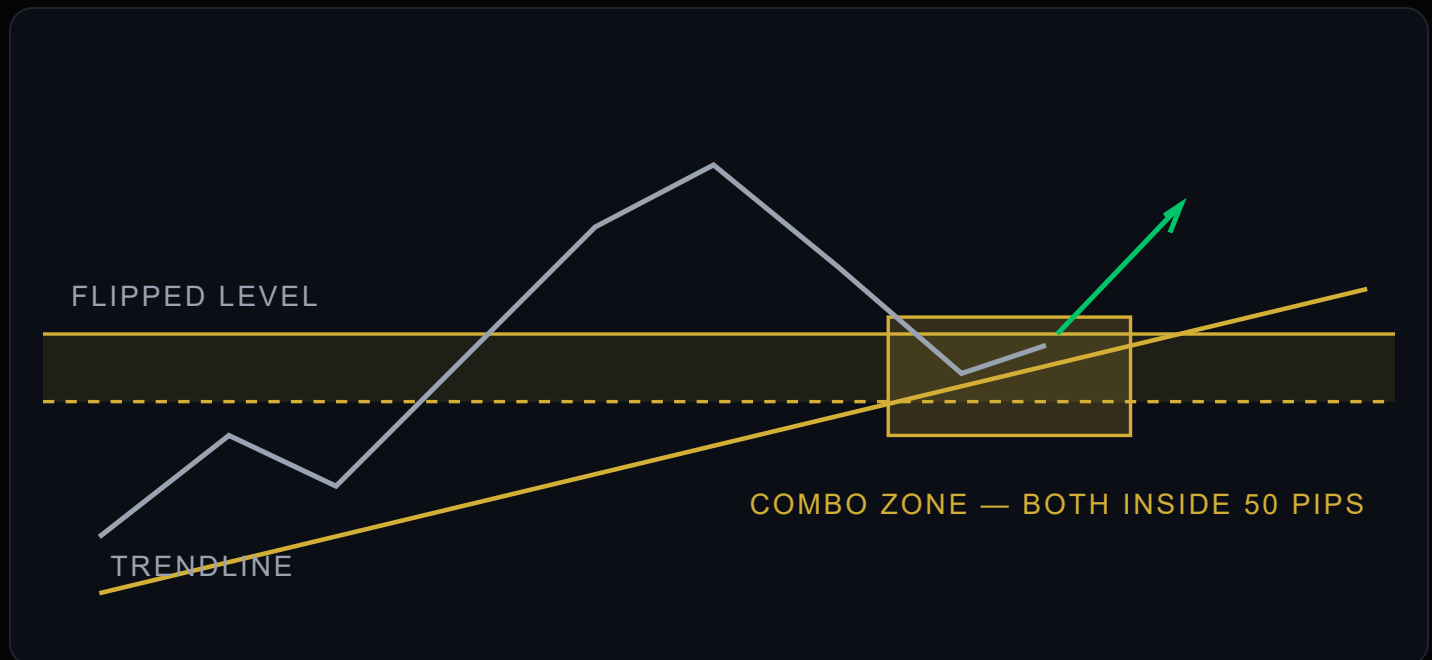
Wait for the zone to line up

Objective — confirm the trendline and the level occupy the same price at the same time.

- Both must sit inside one zone no wider than 50 pips on gold. Wider than that is two separate levels, not a combo.
- The trendline must still be rising when price reaches it. A flat trendline is a range boundary.
- Price has to walk back into the zone. A gap or a single spike through it is not a pullback.
- News lockout: no new entries 30 minutes either side of a high-impact release. Times in MYT.

Fail condition. If you are measuring the zone to decide whether it counts, it does not count.

FIGURE 5



Schematic. Price pulls back into the overlap with the dominant trend behind it. This is the only picture this SOP trades.

Confirm the rejection on H1

Objective — see the market refuse the zone before you commit money to it.

- Drop to H1 once price is inside the zone. Do not drop earlier; you will invent setups.
 - Rejection reads as a long wick into the zone with the body closing back out of it.
 - Wait for the close. A candle still inside the zone is a candle still deciding.
 - Two rejection candles in a row is stronger than one. Three means you are late.
-

Fail condition. No close out of the zone, no trade. You are allowed to miss it.

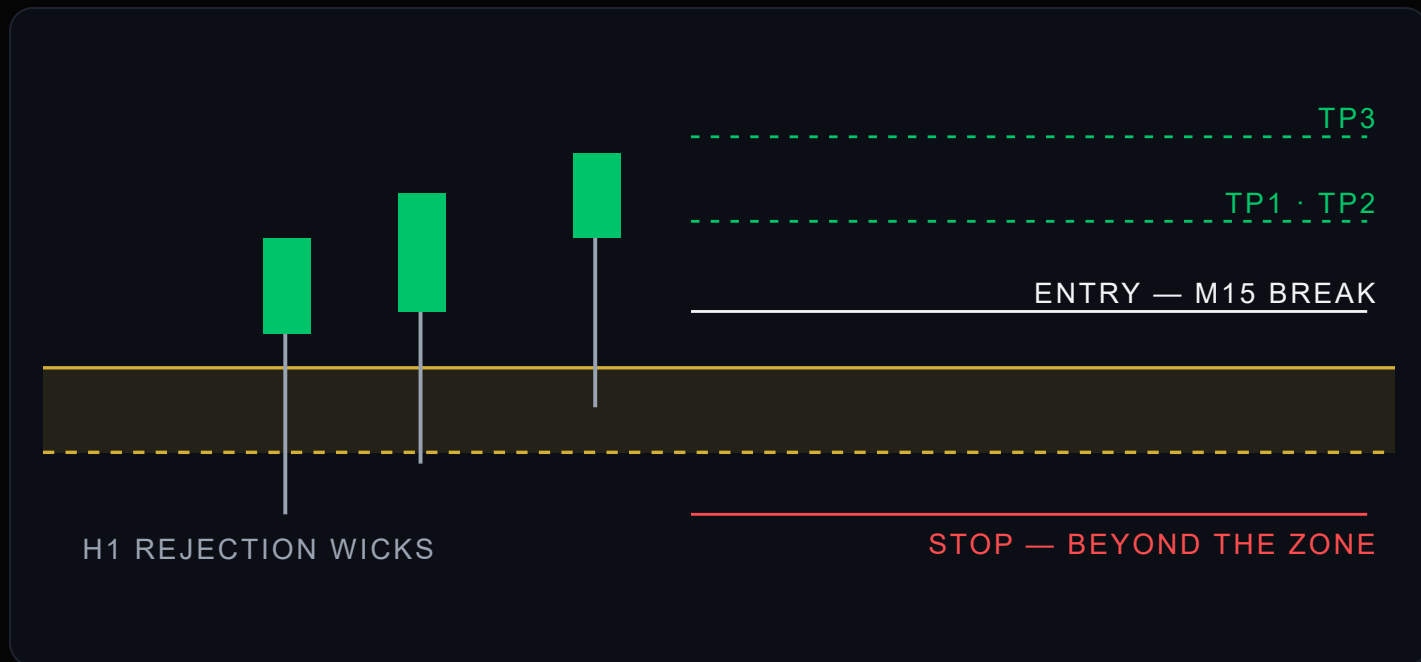
Trigger on M15

Objective — get a tight entry without chasing price.

- Move to M15 only after the H1 candle has closed.
 - In an uptrend the entry is the break of the high of the M15 rejection candle.
 - Use a pending order at that break. Use a market order only if you are already at the screen and the level is 10 pips away.
 - If M15 has not triggered within three candles, the move left without you. Cancel the order.
-

Fail condition. Entering inside the zone because you are afraid of missing it. The zone is where the stop lives, not the entry.

FIGURE 6



Schematic. The wicks go into the zone, the bodies close above it, the entry sits above the bodies and the stop sits below the whole zone.

EXECUTION AND RECORD

A good zone with bad sizing is a bad trade. Fix the loss first, then let the market decide the profit. Everything in Part III is arithmetic you do before the order goes in.

MISSION 07

Stop, targets, size

Objective — know your loss in pips and in R before you know your profit.

- Stop goes beyond the far side of the zone plus 10 pips of spike room. Never inside the zone.
- TP1 at 1R. TP2 at the previous swing high. TP3 at 3R, and only on a trending session.
- Close half at TP1, move the stop to breakeven, let the rest run. Breakeven is not a profit, it is a free option.
- Size so a full stop costs 1% of the account at most. Money management is the only edge you fully control.
- Risk-reward below 1:1.5 to TP2 means no trade, however good the zone looks.

Fail condition. Widening the stop after entry. The stop was the plan; moving it means you have no plan.

MISSION 08

Manage and journal

Objective — make the next combo better than this one.

- Journal every combo you took and every combo you skipped. The skips teach more.
- Record six fields: date, trend on H4, touches on the trendline, zone width in pips, pips to stop, R closed.
- Review weekly. Read the losses first and look for the rule you broke, not the candle that beat you.
- A drawdown of three stops in a week means you stop trading and go back to the journal.

ONE WIN, ONE LOSS

Both setups below are illustrative and marked as samples. They are here to show the SOP applied end to end — including the day it costs you a stop.

XAUUSD
Combo entry
Sample
BUY

ENTRY	STOP LOSS	TP1-3
3 412.80	3 404.20	3 421.00 · 3 429.50 · 3 441.00

Status: CLOSED
+2.4R

H4 was in a clean uptrend with three higher lows. The trendline had a third touch, and a resistance broken two sessions earlier sat 20 pips above it — a 40 pip combo zone. Price pulled back into it, H1 printed a long lower wick and closed above the zone, and M15 triggered on the break of that candle's high. Stop 86 pips below entry, beyond the whole zone. Half closed at TP1, stop to breakeven, the rest ran to TP3 as London handed over. Closed +2.4R.

XAUUSD
Combo entry
Sample
BUY

ENTRY	STOP LOSS	TP1-3
3 366.50	3 357.90	3 375.10 · 3 383.40 · 3 392.30

Status: STOPPED OUT
-1.0R

Same picture, different outcome. Trend was up, the zone was 44 pips wide, H1 rejected it and M15 triggered. Price then came straight back through the zone and closed an H4 candle below it — the level was gone. The stop did its job at -1R. No management would have saved this one, and nothing was wrong with the entry. This is the cost of doing business, and it gets the same card as the win.

DOES IT TRANSFER?

The same combo outside gold

Nothing in missions 01 to 06 is specific to XAUUSD. On a major pair such as EURUSD the structure is identical — trend, trendline, flipped level, rejection, trigger — only the zone width changes, because a 40 pip zone on gold is noise and on EURUSD it is a day's range. Read the zone in the instrument's own volatility, not in a fixed pip count. We publish gold, so gold is what this manual measures.



DAILY SOP CHECKLIST

Run it in order. A no anywhere is a no for the day.

- 01 H4 trend named out loud. Up, down, or sideways.

- 02 Trendline drawn with three touches, not moved since.

- 03 Flipped level marked as a zone, body to wick.

- 04 Trendline and level inside 50 pips of each other.

- 05 Economic calendar checked. No high-impact release inside 30 minutes, MYT.

- 06 H1 rejection candle closed out of the zone.

- 07 M15 pending order set at the break, not inside the zone.

- 08 Stop beyond the zone plus 10 pips. Lot size checked against 1%.

- 09 Risk-reward to TP2 at least 1:1.5.

- 10 Journal row written before the platform is closed.

QUICK REFERENCE CARD

Every number this SOP uses, on one card. Gold values assume XAUUSD.

TRENDLINE TOUCHES	ZONE WIDTH	COMBO OVERLAP
3 minimum	30-60 pips	≤ 50 pips
STOP BUFFER	RISK PER SETUP	MINIMUM RR TO TP2
+10 pips	1% max	1:1.5
TRIGGER EXPIRY	NEWS LOCKOUT	WEEKLY STOP-OUT LIMIT
3 M15 candles	±30 min	3 stops

	Take it	Skip it
Trendline touches	3 or more	2 or fewer
Trendline and level overlap	✓	—
H1 closed out of the zone	✓	—
High-impact news inside 30 min	—	✓
Risk-reward to TP2	1:1.5 or better	below 1:1.5
Entry price	above the zone	inside the zone

GLOSSARY

Support

A price the market has stopped falling at before.

Resistance

A price the market has stopped rising at before.

Level

Support or resistance treated as a zone rather than a single price.

Trendline

A sloping line joining swing lows in an uptrend or swing highs in a downtrend. The dynamic half of the combo.

Higher high · higher low

The two prints that define an uptrend.

Candlestick · body · wick

One period of price. The body is open to close; the wick is the extreme it reached and gave back.

Retest

Price returning to a broken level to trade against it from the other side.

Fakeout

A break that closes back inside. The reason this SOP waits for closes.

Pending order · market order

An order that waits at a price, versus one filled at whatever price is showing.

Entry · stop loss · take profit

Where you get in, where you are wrong, where you get out.

R · risk-reward

One R is the distance from entry to stop. Every result in this manual is counted in R.

Breakeven

Stop moved to entry, so the trade can no longer cost you.

Spike · slippage · liquidity

A violent move, a fill worse than asked, and how much size the market can absorb.

Sideways

No higher highs and lows, no lower highs and lows. No combo.

News lockout

A stated window around high-impact releases in which no new entry is taken.

Money management · drawdown

Sizing so no single loss matters, and the depth of the dip it still creates.

Trading plan · journal

The rules written before the session, and the record written after it.

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